

Macro at a Glance: Latest views and forecasts

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Changes to flag this week:

- **Raised** our 2026 STOXX Europe 600 EPS growth forecast to 15% (from 10%) given the strong Q2 earnings season and resilient economic backdrop.

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Watching

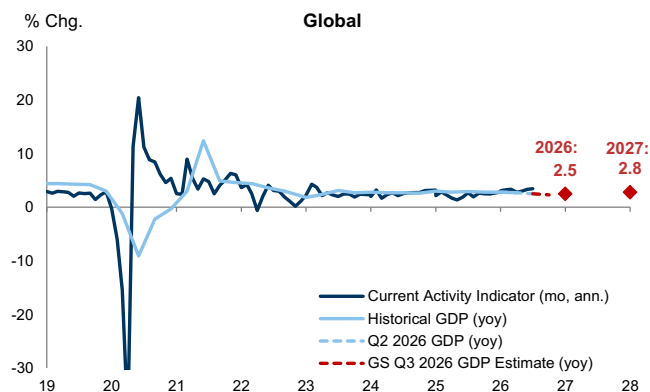
- **Globally**, we expect real GDP growth to slow to 2.5% yoy in 2026 amid headwinds from the rise in energy prices from the conflict in the Middle East. We expect global core inflation to end the year at 2.8%, reflecting a fading tariff boost and further normalization in shelter and wage inflation but a boost from energy price passthrough.
- **In the US**, we expect real GDP growth of 2.1% on a Q4/Q4 basis in 2026, reflecting subdued consumer spending growth but a boost from the AI boom via higher equity wealth as well as strong capex. We expect core PCE inflation of 2.9% in December 2026, boosted by the effects of tariffs, energy price passthrough, and AI demand exaggerated by measurement issues, with it falling closer to 2% in 2027 as those effects subside. We expect the unemployment rate to end 2026 at 4.4%.
- **We expect the Fed** to leave the policy rate unchanged at 3.5-3.75% for the rest of 2026.
- **In the Euro area**, we expect real GDP growth of 0.8% on a Q4/Q4 basis in 2026, reflecting resilient activity data but ongoing headwinds from elevated energy prices as well as subdued consumer confidence. We expect core inflation to rise to a peak of 2.7% yoy in 1Q27, reflecting energy price passthrough, before declining to 2.0% by end-2028.
- **We expect the ECB** to deliver one more 25bp hike in September to a peak policy rate of 2.5%, although the risks are skewed toward further tightening.
- **In China**, we expect real GDP growth of 4.6% yoy in 2026, reflecting an increase in fiscal spending and still-resilient exports but headwinds from weak domestic demand. We expect CPI/PPI inflation to rise to 1.0%/2.0% yoy this year largely owing to commodity price passthrough.
- **WATCH CONFLICT IN THE MIDDLE EAST.** The situation remains fluid amid

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swings between de-escalatory and escalatory headlines, and we will be closely watching how oil flows through the region continue to evolve from here.

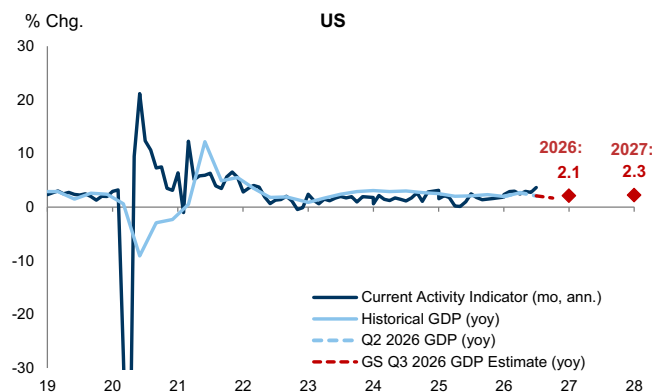
Growth

Global GDP vs. CAI



Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research.

US GDP vs. CAI



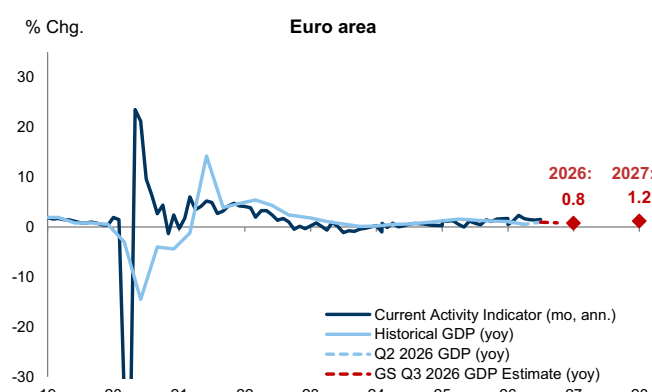
Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research.

China GDP vs. CAI



Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research.

Euro area GDP vs. CAI



Source: Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research.

Forecasts

Key GS economic and market forecasts

Economics							Markets										Equities									
GDP growth (%)	2026				2027		Interest rates 10Yr (%)	Last	E2026	E2027	FX	Last	3m	12m	S&P 500	E2026		E2027		Returns (%)	12m	YTD	E2026 P/E			
	GS (Q4/Q4)	Cons. (Q4/Q4)	GS (CY)	Cons. (CY)	GS (CY)	Cons. (CY)										GS	Cons.	GS	Cons.							
Global	2.4	--	2.5	2.5	2.8	2.6	US	4.70	4.40	4.25	EUR/\$	1.15	1.14	1.12	Price	8,000				S&P 500	7.4	12.9	22.3x			
US	2.1	2.0	2.1	2.2	2.3	2.1	Germany	3.15	3.00	3.00	GBP/\$	1.35	1.33	1.28	EPS	\$340	\$362	\$385	\$407	MXAPJ	24.7	19.9	12.7x			
China	4.6	4.6	4.6	4.6	4.7	4.4	Japan	2.81	2.50	2.25	\$/JPY	159	162	165	Growth	24%	32%	13%	12%	Topix	9.7	20.3	19.7x			
Euro area	0.8	0.9	0.8	0.8	1.2	1.2	UK	4.82	4.50	4.35	\$/CNY	6.73	6.80	6.50						STOXX 600	-0.2	11.6	15.8x			
Policy rates (%)	2026				2027		Commodities			Last	3Q26	4Q26	Credit (bp)	Last	3Q26	4Q26	Consumer	2026		2027		Wage Tracker 2026 (%)				
	GS	Mkt.			GS	Mkt.												CPI (% yoy)	Unemp. Rate	CPI (% yoy)	Unemp. Rate	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	
US	3.63	3.94			3.13	4.01	Crude Oil, Brent (\$/bbl)			89	88	80	USD	IG	78	85	82	US	3.2	4.4	2.3	4.3	3.5	3.6	--	--
Euro area	2.50	2.58			2.00	2.72	Nat Gas, NYMEX (\$/mmBtu)			2.77	3.50	3.50										--	--	--	--	
China	1.40	1.38			1.30	--	Nat Gas, TTF (EUR/MWh)			59.12	60	53	EUR	IG	89	91	88	Euro area	2.9	6.3	2.4	6.2	--	--	--	--
Japan	1.00	1.34			1.50	1.93	Copper (\$/mt)			14,352	13,600	13,700						China	1.0	--	1.0	--	--	--	--	--
							Gold (\$/troy oz)			4,383	4,600	4,836	HY	257	320	315										

GS CAI is a measure of current growth. For more information on the methodology of the CAI please see "Technical Updates to Our Global CAIs," Global Economics Comment, Sep. 01, 2025. Market pricing as of August 11, 2026.

Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research.

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